

United Overseas Bank (UOB)

First Take: UOB: PPop miss, provisions scaled up, stock may stay weak for now

Our First Take: UOB announced 3Q25 PPop of S\$1,863mn, down 17% y/y, 3% q/q and 2% below JPMe. NII and NIM were in line with our estimates (NIM 1.82% vs. 1.84% 2Q exit). Revenue weakness was led by fees, down 3% q/q, despite a better quarter at treasury. Costs were in line as well, with CIR slightly above at 45.2% for the qtr. LDR was lower by almost 100bps q/q. AQ was weak, with NPAs up 8% q/q (NPL ratio up 4bps to 1.6%). New NPA formation of S\$838mn (~1% of loans, ann) during the quarter was significantly above the last 10-quarter run-rate; as were upgrades, recoveries and write-offs. SPs increased to 55bps (ann) and total provisions moved to 158bps (ann), which included S\$615mn of one-off GPs (71bps of provisions, ann). Coverage ratio has improved to 100% (from 88% last quarter). The bank guided for DPS policy to remain steady (50% payout), but payout will exclude the one-off provisions. Yet, given that SPs are also running high and PPop missed, we expect a y/y decline in 2025 DPS, unless the bank pays a special.

The scale of provisions, as well as 'total credit cost' guidance of 25-30bps next year suggests this may be the last spike in provisions. To that extent, these results may be the beginning of stabilization in asset quality concerns. Yet, we expect the Street to evaluate at least one more quarter of performance on underlying trends before moving on from this concern. Hence, in the near term, we expect the stock to remain weak. We maintain UW.

Key Positives

Deposit growth was impressive at 4% q/q, with loan growth coming in slightly better as well. Costs were managed in line with expectations. The bank guided for no change to dividend, with pre-emptive GPs not affecting 2025 provisions. NNM was S\$5bn in 3Q, with improvement in invested AUM to 41%.

Key Negatives/Question Marks

NPL formation was elevated in the quarter, with SPs higher at 55bps ann. Fee income was weaker than expected, likely on higher cost expense as gross fee income saw q/q improvement.

Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect negative revisions post results.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect weak stock price performance post results.

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Underweight

UOBH.SI, UOB SP

Price (05 Nov 25): S\$34.87

Price Target (Dec-26): S\$32.50



APAC Banks

Harsh Wardhan Modi ^{AC}

(65) 6882-2450

harsh.w.modi@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities Singapore Private Limited/
J.P. Morgan Securities (Asia Pacific) Limited/ J.P.
Morgan Broking (Hong Kong) Limited

Daniel Andrew Tan, CFA

(63-2) 8554-2413

danielandrew.o.tan@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities Philippines, Inc.

Conference Call Details

UOB is hosting a media briefing at 8:45am HKT and an analyst briefing at 9:45am HKT today. Please let us know if you are keen to join.

Table 1: UOB: 3Q25 earnings review

P&L (\$mn)	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25A	3Q25E	YoY	QoQ	JPMe
Net Interest Income	2,401	2,460	2,451	2,409	2,336	2,265	2,254	-8%	-3%	0%
Non-Interest Income	1,075	1,374	1,010	1,248	1,129	1,133	1,185	-18%	0%	-4%
Fee Income	618	630	567	694	636	615	649	-2%	-3%	-5%
Other Non-Il	457	744	443	554	493	518	536	-30%	5%	-3%
Operating Revenue	3,476	3,834	3,461	3,657	3,465	3,398	3,439	-11%	-2%	-1%
Operating Costs	(1,452)	(1,590)	(1,558)	(1,559)	(1,535)	(1,535)	(1,538)	-3%	0%	0%
PPOP	2,024	2,244	1,903	2,097	1,930	1,863	1,901	-17%	-3%	-2%
Impairment Charge	(238)	(311)	(235)	(297)	(288)	(1,368)	(381)	340%	375%	259%
Other Income	30	25	40	22	(3)	25	40	0%	NM	-37%
Pre-Tax	1,816	1,958	1,708	1,822	1,639	520	1,560	-73%	-68%	-67%
Core profit	1,488	1,638	1,540	1,490	1,338	443	1,325	-73%	-67%	-67%
Non-Recurring Items	(64)	(28)	(17)	-	-	-	-	-100%	NM	NM
Reported profit	1,424	1,610	1,523	1,490	1,338	443	1,325	-72%	-67%	-67%
DPS (\$)	0.88	-	1.17	-	1.10	-	-	NM	NM	NM
Gross Loans	327,600	333,998	337,831	341,154	342,900	351,084	346,547	5%	2%	1%
Deposits	389,157	400,784	403,978	401,250	405,076	419,660	411,135	5%	4%	2%
NPL	4,888	4,852	5,164	5,458	5,341	5,617	5,341	16%	5%	5%
NPA	4,952	5,055	5,210	5,361	5,386	5,809	5,386	15%	8%	8%
Total Allowances	4,851	5,026	4,764	4,829	4,765	5,787	4,933	15%	21%	17%
								Change in bps		
NIM	2.05%	2.05%	2.00%	2.00%	1.91%	1.82%	1.82%	(23)	(9)	(0)
CIR	41.8%	41.5%	45.0%	42.6%	44.3%	45.2%	44.7%	370	87	46
LDR	84.2%	83.3%	83.6%	85.0%	84.7%	83.7%	84.3%	32	(99)	(63)
CASA Ratio	51.5%	53.6%	54.6%	55.1%	56.5%	56.5%	56.3%	289	0	18
Credit Costs (bps)	24	34	25	34	33	158	44	124	125	113
NPL Ratio	1.49%	1.45%	1.53%	1.60%	1.56%	1.60%	1.54%	15	4	6
NPA Coverage	98%	99%	91%	90%	88%	100%	90%	100	1,200	1,000
CET1 (fully phased-in)	13.4%	15.2%	15.4%	15.4%	15.2%	14.6%	14.5%	(61)	(57)	6

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

United Overseas Bank (UOB) *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$32.50)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on UOB.

- UOB has delivered RoE with the least volatility among Singapore banks over the past 20 years. This may change over the next few quarters, as asset quality is incrementally showing up as a risk. We expect 11.1-12% RoE in the next 3Y, with 16/13bps NIM compression in 2025/26, and credit costs at ~40bps (ann) for next six quarters.
- Commercial real estate in US and HK are key sources of risk to credit costs. Select EM Asean markets are also sources of risk for the bank.
- Following increased spend in the last 2Y, we expect cost control to be a focus, supporting efficiency improvements.
- Management's commitment to 14-14.5% CET1 by 2027 vs. 15.1% fully phased-in as of 2Q25 provides visibility on the capital return. We expect S\$750mn annual buyback over next 3Y, which is broadly in line with guidance and largely known.
- On the other hand, the bank has committed to 50% payout ratio, for regular dividends. Hence, as EPS risk increases, DPS will be at risk as well. This should be one of the catalysts for weaker stock price.
- Valuations for the bank could be at risk, as AQ-related worries will increasingly start to dominate.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of S\$32.5 is based on a fair P/B of 1.03x with a normalized RoE of 11.1%, a risk-free rate of 4.5%, a cost of capital of 10.8% and a growth rate of 0.5%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Downside catalysts include credit cost increases, growth and NIM disappointments, and lower-than-expected dividends and buyback. Higher operating costs would also be a downside risk. Higher-than-anticipated digital investment spending could be a drag on profitability.

Upside risks include sustained delivery on RoE, cost management post investments in 2023-24, and higher dividend. On PPoP, the bank's ability to manage early wins from its digital investments could lead to positive revisions, and investments coming to fruition earlier than anticipated would pose upside risks to costs.

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United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 24, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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